

STAGE NINE • ENGLISH VOCABULARY FIRST SET

FIRSTS

COMPLETION CRITERIA

What counts as done, and how it triggers the Stage Nine credential

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Completion Criteria & Credential Trigger

Stage Nine • English Vocabulary First Set

PURPOSE

This document defines exactly what “complete” means for Stage Nine, at both the individual FIRST level and the full-stage level, and how completion connects to the program's credentialing system. Because this stage is fundamentally about active, spoken and written language production, its standard is explicitly stricter about originality and live participation than a stage built around reflection alone.

Per-FIRST Standard

STANDARD

A FIRST counts as complete when the corresponding Templates worksheet shows genuine, correct, original sentences using the vocabulary — not copied definitions, not single-word answers, and not the example sentences provided in the Manual repeated verbatim.

Stage-Level Completion Checklist

- All 38 Templates worksheets completed with genuine, original sentences demonstrating active, correct use.
- Attendance or async completion confirmed for all 6 sessions.
- Genuine spoken participation confirmed in at least the major live-practice FIRSTS (M16, M17, M26, M30 at minimum), verified by facilitator observation during the session rather than worksheet review alone, since these are fundamentally spoken skills.
- One specific word or phrase named at the stage close that the participant identifies as genuinely likely to continue using.

Facilitator Sign-Off

The facilitator reviews each participant's completed Templates workbook for genuine, original sentence construction (not copied examples) and confirms, from direct observation during sessions, that the participant engaged in live spoken practice for the major speaking-focused FIRSTS. Spot-check for genuine originality specifically — a worksheet using the Manual's own example sentences verbatim should not be marked complete.

Credential Trigger

HOW THE BADGE WORKS

Upon facilitator sign-off, the participant's record is marked "Stage Nine Complete" in the program tracker, which triggers the Stage Nine digital badge. As with every stage, badges accumulate visibly; the full-program certificate is issued only once all 16 stages are marked complete.